

KIDS SCIENCE PODCAST SCRIPT SPECIFICATION

Standard Operating Procedure & Skill Guideline for Script Editors & Writers

Format: Solo Monologue	Duration: 10–12 Mins	Target: Kids Aged 7–10	Theme: What Happened On This Day
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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & MISSION

This specification defines the creative, pedagogical, and technical standards for producing solo podcast scripts aimed at children aged 7–10. The core franchise theme is **"What Happened On This Day"**—a daily time-travel adventure exploring science, space, history, human biology, and groundbreaking inventions.

CORE MISSION

Transform abstract scientific concepts and historical facts into vivid, auditory-first visual adventures. Keep 7–10-year-olds hooked through storytelling, relatable analogies, and interactive micro-missions without condescending "baby talk."

2. TARGET DEMOGRAPHIC & HOST PERSONA

Target Audience (Ages 7–10 / Elementary Schoolers)

- **Cognitive Profile:** Highly inquisitive, understands multi-step logical cause-and-effect, eager to explore "why."
- **Attention Span:** Auditory attention span is 3–4 minutes per concept block. Requires structural resets and interactive prompts.
- **Psychological Drivers:** Wants to feel mature and smart. Strongly rejects childish slang, condescending tone, or nursery-school style repetition.

Host Persona: "The Cool Science Explorer"

- **Role & Vibe:** A curious, energetic, and relatable partner in exploration (like a time-traveling science detective).
- **Voice:** Second-person ("you"), warm, authentic, conversational, and enthusiastic.
- **Strict Ban List:** No baby talk/reduplicative words ("doggy", "tummy-wummy"), no dry academic lectures, and no flat scripted reading.

3. AUDIO-FIRST WRITING PRINCIPLES

- **Write for the Ear:** Use punchy, short sentences. Avoid complex subordinate clauses. Use colloquial bridges ("And guess what?", "Here's the crazy twist...") instead of formal literary connectors.
- **Pseudo-Spontaneous Delivery:** Script intentional pauses, gasps, and moment-of-realization markers (`[Pause 2s]` , `[Gasp]` , `[Whisper]`) to simulate genuine live discovery.
- **Sonic Worldbuilding:** Embed audio cues (`[SFX]`) and music shifts (`[BGM]`) every 45–60 seconds to maintain high auditory stimulation in lieu of visual cues.

4. UNIVERSAL 10–12 MINUTE EPISODE STRUCTURE

TIME BLOCK	MODULE NAME	SCRIPTING STRATEGY & REQUIREMENTS
0:00 – 1:30	1. Time Machine Hook	Start with a counter-intuitive question or high-stakes scene. Announce today's date, launch the time machine, and set the episode mission. Hook within 15 seconds.
1:30 – 5:00	2. Narrative Drama	Tell the historical event as a character-driven story. Personify key elements (e.g., space probes, bacteria, machines). Build tension around a core obstacle.
5:00 – 8:30	3. Scientific Deep-Dive	Explain the core science in 2 simple steps . Mandatory requirement: Include 1 concrete everyday metaphor and 1 physical micro-interaction .
8:30 – 10:30	4. Modern World Twist	Reframe the historical event: show how it directly impacts the child's life today. Bust a popular myth or reveal an unexpected fun fact.
10:30 – 12:00	5. Outro & Mission	Provide a 30-second rapid recap. Assign a safe, real-world "Daily Science Observation Task" to do offline. Deliver closing catchphrase.

5. SCRIPT FORMATTING & MARKUP STANDARDS

All submitted scripts must strictly utilize the standardized audio tags:

- **[SFX: <Description>]** — Ambient sounds, action accents (e.g., **[SFX: Laser beam power up]** , **[SFX: Clock ticking fast]**)
- **[BGM: <Mood/Action>]** — Musical transitions (e.g., **[BGM: Transition to playful jazz]** , **[BGM: Mysterious suspense fade in]**)
- **[Voice: <Direction>]** — Delivery instructions (e.g., **[Voice: Excited whisper]** , **[Voice: Slow down dramatically]**)
- **[Action: <Physical Prompt>]** — Interactive listener action (e.g., **[Action: Tell listener to tap their desk 3 times]**)

6. EVERYDAY METAPHOR DATABASE EXAMPLES

THE METAPHOR RULE

Never leave a scientific term standalone without a real-life anchor object that a 7-year-old can instantly visualize.

- **Astronomy / Gravity:** Space-time is a giant elastic trampoline; Gravity is an invisible suction cup.
- **Microbiology / Immunology:** White blood cells are castle guards; Viruses are sneaky tricksters wearing fake badges.
- **Physics / Heat:** Microwaves act like a hyper-fast dance party for water molecules.
- **Genetics / DNA:** The nucleus is a master library; DNA is a giant LEGO instruction booklet.

7. QUALITY ASSURANCE CHECKLIST FOR SCRIPT EDITORS

- ☐ **Hook Test:** Does the first 15 seconds contain an irresistible hook or surprising question?

- ☐ **Tone Check:** Is the tone peer-to-peer ("Cool Science Explorer"), avoiding baby talk and strict lecturing?
- ☐ **Pacing & Length:** Is the script structured for 10–12 mins (~2,000–2,400 Chinese characters / 1,400–1,600 English words)?
- ☐ **Audio Density:** Are sound effects ([SFX]) and music changes ([BGM]) annotated every 45–60 seconds?
- ☐ **Relatable Metaphor:** Is there at least ONE vivid everyday metaphor explaining the core scientific concept?
- ☐ **Micro-Interaction:** Is there a physical or cognitive prompt keeping the child actively participating?
- ☐ **Take-Home Task:** Does the episode end with an actionable, safe offline observation mission?